

The King of Light Who Takes Away the Burning

Toh 784 · Derge Kangyur

བསམ་གྱི་གསལ་འདོན་གྱི་རྒྱུ་པོ་

This short text is a dhāraṇī, a protective incantation, dedicated to the buddha known in Tibetan as Bsreg gsol 'od kyi rgyal po, rendered in English as the King of Light who takes away the burning. It begins, as is customary, with homage to the Three Jewels and to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete buddha, before moving into the mantra itself, which opens with the syllables "huré huré." I cannot determine from the material at hand a reliable Sanskrit title or the precise purpose the dhāraṇī is meant to serve, though the name of the buddha suggests it concerns relief from burning or suffering. The text is Toh 784 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of tantra-section works, among the many short dhāraṇī and ritual texts preserved there.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete buddha, the King of Light who takes away the burning.

Tadyathā: huré huré, huṭa gatani.

Translator's Notes

- The buddha's name is rendered according to the Tibetan, bsreg gsol 'od kyi rgyal po. This probably corresponds to a Sanskrit name along the lines of "King of Light of the Burning Offering" (such as a fire-offering or smoke-offering buddha), but the Tibetan is compressed. A reading such as "King of Light invoked in the burning-offering" is also possible; I have chosen the sense of removing or consuming the burning, but this is a consequential choice. The dhāraṇī is left in transliteration as it stands, and since the passage ends mid-formula after "huṭa gatani," it is evidently an excerpt of a longer mantra. Tadyathā means "it is thus," the standard opening of a dhāraṇī, and is left untranslated.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.